

Figure 4.15 *Chisht, mausoleums (or* madrasa*/mosque complex), ruins: Mausoleum A, interior, arch, with inscription, detail. © Photograph Josephine Powell* c. *1960. Harvard Fine Arts Library, Special Collections.*

Nishapur and Herat, and in less traveled reaches.[79] Although the followers of Sufi masters originated in various rungs of society – ranging from lay devotees of prosperous mercantile backgrounds through artisans and craftspeople, as well as the indigent poor – true renunciants (*murid*) would eventually coalesce as orders (*tariqa*) around their *pir*s, coming to be associated with specific *khanaqah*s. There was great variation among Sufi *tariqa*s in both geographical reach and longevity, with some attaining hereditary followings (*silsila*) able to spread the *pir*'s teachings far and wide through a process of associative fragmentation: new *silsila*s could be established, particularly in areas at a distance from their spiritual order's origin, yet remain affiliated, even loosely, with the memory of the initial *pir* and the spiritual teachings attributed to him.[80] The eponymous Chishtiyya was just such a Sufi order, having associations with the locality of Chisht as early as the ninth century, but attaining its